PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, January 27, 2026

Work Session and Special Meeting

Meeting Minutes

(Adopted 2/24/26)

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In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at:
https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Work Session and Special Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held virtually and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Present:
Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller, Stephanie Engelsman, Virginia LaForte, Christy Splitt, and Patte Sullivan; Student Representative Ian Ritorto; and Superintendent Kimberlee Armstrong

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 6:05 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Bond Update

Time: 6:06 pm

Staff: Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff; Sarah Norman – Executive Director, Procedeo; and TJ Hopkins – Senior Director Bond Program

Staff provided a monthly bond update, including the current status of bond projects, procurement and construction timelines, and an overview of the bond program dashboards showing overall spending, project completion, and outstanding work. Staff also noted plans to establish a pool of contractors to support multiple projects as needed.

Board members asked questions and provided comments on topics including the potential use of remaining 2012 bond funds, seismic upgrades, procurement methods and schedules, and athletic project timing. Staff noted that 2012 bond funds may be used for seismic upgrades as are consistent with the project scope outlined in the 2012 bond package. Further clarification was provided regarding group procurement and contracting process. It was noted that a meeting was held with Portland Parks and Recreation regarding Powell Park athletic improvements. Staff confirmed their intent to prioritize local, minority-owned, and women-owned businesses, while recognizing that some specialized work may require out-of-state contractors.

2026 Legislative Priorities (Resolution 7240)

Time: 6:52 pm

Staff: Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff and Ben Gurewitz – Senior Manager of Government Affairs

Staff provided an overview of the proposed legislative priorities for the upcoming short session, including the session's focus and recommended advocacy positions, with an emphasis on seeking additional education funding.

Board members asked questions and provided comments on topics including funding advocacy, use of the Education Stability Fund by the state to improve school funding, and coordination on legislative engagement with students, community and union partners. Discussion included support for protections for students from immigrant families, maintaining funding for summer learning programs, and positions related to state funding measures, including proposed changes to the "kicker" formula and other education-related legislation. Clarification was also provided regarding the role of individual board members in legislative advocacy and the timing and strategy of upcoming lobby efforts.

Actions Taken:

- Director Splitt moved and Vice-Chair DePass seconded the motion to adopt Resolution 7240, Resolution to Approve 2026 Legislative Priorities, as amended. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (7 yes – 0 no – 0 abstain)

  Chase-Miller: Yes; DePass: Yes; Engelsman: Yes; La Forte: Yes; Splitt: Yes; Sullivan: Yes; Wang: Yes; Student Representative Ritorto: Yes (unofficial)

Subsidiary Motions:

- Director Splitt moved and Director Chase-Miller seconded the motion to amend the legislative priorities to add “additional” to No Unfunded Mandates. (7 yes – 0 no – 0 abstain)

  Chase-Miller: Yes; DePass: Yes; Engelsman: Yes; La Forte: Yes; Splitt: Yes; Sullivan: Yes; Wang: Yes; Student Representative Ritorto: Yes (unofficial)

Consent Agenda (Resolutions 7241 and 7242)

Time: 7:36 pm

Staff: Dr. Jon Franco – Senior Chief of Operations; Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff; and Sarah Norman – Executive Director, Procedeo

There was discussion regarding contracts for seismic services, focusing on how schools were selected for projects and how those decisions intersect with ongoing right-sizing and consolidation planning. Board members expressed concern about the lack of clarity around the selection process, including the equity lens, risk scores, and data used, while also cautioning against delaying safety-related work. Staff explained that the seismic projects for the contracts on the agenda are funded through the 2020 bond, not the 2025 bond, with much of the work not scheduled to begin until 2027. It was noted that plans can shift if needed as consolidation decisions are made, and committed to bringing a detailed seismic project overview to a full board work session.

Actions Taken:

- Director Sullivan moved and Vice-Chair DePass seconded the motion to adopt the Consent Agenda, including Resolutions 7241 and 7242. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (7 yes – 0 no – 0 abstain)

  Chase-Miller: Yes; DePass: Yes; Engelsman: Yes; La Forte: Yes; Splitt: Yes; Sullivan: Yes; Wang: Yes; Student Representative Ritorto: Yes (unofficial)

Other / Future Topics

8:09 pm

It was noted that Board leadership and staff are continuing to consider some of the topics that have been previously requested.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned by Board Chair Eddie Wang at 8:10 pm.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant/Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools

Resolutions As Adopted

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Resolution No. 7240

Resolution to Approve 2026 Legislative Priorities

RESOLUTION

The Board adopts the 2026 Legislative Priorities as the formal position of the Board of Education for the 2026 Oregon Legislative Session.

RESOLUTION No. 7241

Expenditure Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Public Contracting Rules PPS-45-0200 ("Authority to Approve District Contracts; Delegation of Authority to Superintendent") requires the Board of Education ("Board") enter into contracts and approve payment for products, materials, supplies, capital outlay, equipment, and services whenever the total amount exceeds $150,000 per contract, excepting settlement or real property agreements. Contracts meeting this criterion are listed below.

RESOLUTION

The Superintendent recommends that the Board approve these contracts. The Board accepts this recommendation and by this resolution authorizes the Deputy Clerk to enter into the following agreements.

NEW CONTRACTS

Contractor	Contract Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Contract Amount	Responsible Admin, Funding Source	Certified Business
Opsis Architecture	1/28/2026 Through 1/28/2029 Option to renew for three additional one-year terms through 1/28/2032	Architecture ARCH 97456	Architecture and Engineering Design services for Vernon and Winterhaven Seismic Rehabilitation Request for Proposals 2025-038	$462,665	T. Odgers Fund: 459 Dept: 5511	No
Critical Response Group	2/1/2026 Through 7/1/2031	Related Services RS 97470	Mapping for interoperability with Bureau of Emergency Communications and other public safety partners. Sole Source, PPS 48-0200 2(c)	$403,437	J. Franco Funds: 101, 205 Dept: 5530	No

*A Certified Business is a for-profit business certified as a Minority-Owned Businesses (MBE), Women-Owned Businesses (WBE), Emerging Small Businesses (ESB), and/or Service-Disabled Veteran Businesses (SDV) by the State of Oregon Certification Office for Business Inclusion and Diversity.

NEW COOPERATIVE PURCHASING AGREEMENTS

No New Cooperative Purchasing Agreements

NEW INTERGOVERNMENTAL AGREEMENTS ("IGAs")

No New Intergovernmental Agreements

AMENDMENTS TO EXISTING CONTRACTS

Contractor	Amendment Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Amendment Amount; New Contract Amount	Responsible Administrator, Funding Source	Certified Business
Miller Nash LLP	9/10/2025 Through 12/31/2026	Legal Services LS 96887 Amendment 1	Amendment continues new and ongoing legal services as needed. Direct Negotiation - Legal Services PPS-46-0525(13)	$400,000 $800,000	S. Toncray Fund: 101 Dept: 5460	No

RESOLUTION No. 7242

A Resolution Appointing a Deputy Clerk

RECITALS

A. ORS 332.515 requires the board of directors of a school district to appoint the chief administrative officer of the district as the district school clerk and authorizes the board to appoint a qualified deputy clerk or clerks to perform the functions of the school clerk.

B. Given the volume of records, contracts, and other legal documents that must be managed and executed on behalf of the District each year, the District Board of Education (the "Board") deems it advisable to appoint a deputy clerk to assist the Superintendent.

C. On July 22, 2025, the Board appointed Chief Financial Officer Michelle Morrison as Deputy Clerk of Portland Public Schools for the 2025-26 fiscal year.

D. The appointment resolution, Resolution No. 7144, did not enumerate, in detail, the role and authority of the Deputy Clerk.

E. Neither statute nor policy enumerates the role and authority of a deputy clerk.

F. The Board therefore deems it advisable to clarify the deputy clerk's role and authority in the appointment resolution.

RESOLVED

1. The Board reaffirms the appointment of Chief Financial Officer Michelle Morrison as Deputy Clerk of Portland Public Schools for the 2025-26 fiscal year.

2. The Deputy Clerk is empowered to exercise the authority of the Superintendent to execute all legal documents on behalf of the District, including without limitation contracts, grant agreements, transactional documents relating to the acquisition or disposition of an interest in real property, and any other legal document that the Superintendent has authority to execute on behalf of the District under statute, Board policy, administrative regulation, Board resolution, or as otherwise authorized by the Board or Oregon law.